

The Washington Post

Prices may vary in areas outside metropolitan Washington.

RE V1 V2 V3 V4



Mostly sunny 85/70 • Tomorrow: T-storm 84/68 **B6**

Democracy Dies in Darkness

FRIDAY, JUNE 6, 2025 • \$4

On D-Day anniversary, the remaining few



GARETH FULLER/PA IMAGES/GETTY IMAGES

D-Day veterans, from left, Ken Hay, Richard Aldred, Henry Rice, Jim Grant and John Dennet pose for a picture Thursday on Sword Beach in Coleville-Montgomery, France, ahead of Friday's 81st anniversary. The dwindling group, now mostly centenarians, have returned with the same message they fought for then: Freedom is worth defending.

Flights at National will be halted during parade

BY LORI ARATANI,
IAN DUNCAN,
OLIVIA GEORGE
AND EMMA UBER

Reagan National Airport is expected to halt takeoffs and landings for several hours on June 14 to accommodate military flyovers and other events on the National Mall that are part of the U.S. Army's 250th birthday celebration, with aviation officials forecasting disruptions for more than 100 flights and thousands of passengers.

FAA warns of hours-long disruptions June 14 while Army celebrates 250th

The celebration, which coincides with President Donald Trump's 79th birthday, is scheduled to include flights by 50 Army helicopters above a military parade featuring tanks and troops. The Army's Golden Knights will parachute onto the Ellipse near

the White House and present an American flag to Trump. A fireworks display is also planned.

The activity will require the Federal Aviation Administration to suspend passenger traffic at the airport, according to the Metropolitan Washington Airports Authority; the airport is across the Potomac River from the Mall. On Jan. 29, a midair collision of an Army Black Hawk helicopter and a regional passenger jet on final approach over the river killed 67 people. An investigation continues while officials have pointed

fingers over continued conflicts between military and civilian aircraft in the nearby airspace.

The airport is expected to be severely disrupted between 6 p.m. and 9:30 p.m., according to an FAA briefing document outlining the tentative plan obtained by The Washington Post.

The agency forecasts that about 100 flights will be held at their departure airports and delayed for an average of nearly three hours, according to the document. A limited number of departures

SEE AIRPORT ON A20

Trump and Musk trade threats as alliance flames out

BOTH FACE POLITICAL AND FINANCIAL RISKS

President floats slashing CEO's government contracts

BY CAT ZAKRZEWSKI,
FAIZ SIDDIQUI
AND ELIZABETH DWOSKIN

The alliance between President Donald Trump and Elon Musk spectacularly imploded Thursday as the world's most prominent bromance collapsed into mutual public trolling.

For months, as Musk emerged as the president's constant companion and self-proclaimed "first buddy," the question hovered of how long a duet could last between two men used to soloing on center stage. Thursday's angry exchanges provided a definitive answer.

The breakup also highlighted the political and financial risks

each man could now face from a prolonged quarrel: Musk, who spent at least \$288 million in 2024 to help elect Trump and other Republicans, accused the president of "such ingratitude" and publicly mused about starting a third party.

Trump responded by threatening Musk's government contracts. The stock price of Tesla, the electric vehicle company Musk owns, fell sharply, down 14 percent at the market close. The value of Trump's meme coin also dropped.

The very public flameout was

SEE MUSK ON A5

SpaceX: Musk's threat to cut craft access would be blow to NASA. **A8**

Claim of anti-straight bias wins at high court

Justices strike standard that majority groups must meet a higher bar

BY JUSTIN JOUVENAL

The Supreme Court on Thursday sided with a straight woman who claimed she faced bias in the workplace after she was passed over for positions that went to gay colleagues. The decision will make it easier for people who are White, male or not gay to prove job discrimination claims.

The justices unanimously

struck down a standard, used in nearly half of the nation's federal circuits, that required members of groups that historically have not faced discrimination to meet a higher bar to prove workplace bias than members of minority groups.

Justice Ketanji Brown Jackson, the only Black woman on the high court, wrote the opinion that sided with Marlean Ames, an Ohio state government employee who argued it was unconstitutional to have different standards for different groups of people.

SEE RULING ON A4

Tax exemptions: Justices back Catholic Charities unanimously. **A5**

President keeps deck of orders ready to deal out

Travel ban the latest executive action crafted to meet the moment

BY NATALIE ALLISON,
EMILY DAVIES
AND MICHAEL BIRNBAUM

Months before President Donald Trump issued a travel ban on individuals from more than a dozen countries, his team of lawyers and advisers had already started crafting the ban, a process that was underway before he stepped back into the Oval Office in January.

Trump announced the proclamation Wednesday night — three days after an Egyptian man with an expired tourist visa was charged with attacking pro-Israel demonstrators in Boulder, Colorado — explaining that the recent crime "underscores the danger posed to our country by foreign nationals not properly vetted."

"We don't want 'em," Trump said in a video announcing the ban.

But a White House official, speaking on condition of anonymity, confirmed that Wednesday night's proclamation "was not a direct response to" the Colorado attack. Trump was always going to implement a travel ban, his advisers say.

The announcement was the latest example of how the Trump administration has dipped into its large reserve of proclamations and executive orders — many of which have been long in the making — to drive their chosen narrative, push the president's priorities and sometimes change the subject when news coverage focuses on topics they prefer to downplay.

Throughout Trump's second term, White House staff have maintained a stash of executive orders and proclamations they can deploy depending on the themes of the moment and the narratives they want to shape, a senior White House official said, speaking on the condition of anonymity to talk frankly about internal strategies.

Some orders are put into the calendar well in advance, the official said. Others are teed up the night before they are signed depending on impulse, political strategy and the overall mood within the White House, the official said.

On this occasion, Trump invoked the recent attack in Colorado as an example of why the new measure was needed, even though Egypt is not one of the countries listed in the proclamation.

SEE TRUMP ON A9

Travel ban: Order shows president learned from past missteps. **A6**



MICHAEL S. WILLIAMSON/THE WASHINGTON POST

Welcome for a NATO partner

President Donald Trump greets German Chancellor Friedrich Merz at the White House for talks on trade and defense, kicking off a string of meetings with Washington's allies. **Story, A13**

Europe frets over reliance on U.S. intelligence

BY GREG MILLER,
SOUAD MEKHENNET
AND ELLEN FRANCIS

BERLIN — The CIA's station chief here delivered an alarming piece of intelligence to Germany's spy agency last year, according to German and U.S. officials: Russia was planning to assassinate the chief executive of Germany's largest arms manufacturer.

The German government responded by surrounding Rheinmetall CEO Armin Papperger — whose company is a major supplier of munitions to Ukraine — with a security detail as large as the one assigned to the chancellor. German intelligence services then began scouring their own sources for more information on the plot, including whether Russia had operatives in place for

such a brazen operation, the officials said.

But a year later, Germany's understanding of the threat still consists almost entirely of what it was told by the CIA, the officials said, speaking on the condition of anonymity to discuss sensitive

SEE EUROPE ON A14

NATO military budget: Alliance is likely to sharply hike spending. **A12**

\$12 million in U.S. aid may end up destroyed

BY MEG KELLY,
JOYCE SOHYUN LEE,
JON SWAINE
AND SARAH BLASKEY

More than \$12 million worth of contraceptives and HIV-prevention medications bought by the U.S. government as aid for developing countries under programs that have since been discontinued will probably be destroyed unless officials sell or otherwise off-load them, an examination by The Washington Post found.

Government records obtained by The Post reveal that virtually all of the supplies have been sitting in distribution centers — one in Belgium and one in the United Arab Emirates — since January, when President Donald Trump halted spending by the U.S. Agency for International Development, saying it was "not aligned with American interests." Much of the material is already closer to expiration than many countries would typically accept.

International humanitarian groups and other organizations have been in talks with government representatives about taking control of the products and distributing them, people with

SEE USAID ON A12

IN THE NEWS

Travel ban Some Jewish leaders object to President Donald Trump's linking his policy to a recent attack on the community, saying it dilutes their concerns about antisemitism. **A6**

Cleanup underway in Maryland Work began quickly after 2,000 gallons of diesel fuel spilled into Baltimore Harbor. **B1**

THE NATION
In Chicago, several people were detained after attending immigration check-ins. **A3**
The government must reinstate AmeriCorps grants in 24 states and D.C., a judge ruled. **A5**

THE WORLD
Dehorning endangered rhinos reduced poaching by 78 percent, a study found. **A10**
The bodies of an Israeli American couple killed on Oct. 7, 2023, were recovered from Gaza. **A14**

THE ECONOMY
Starbase, SpaceX's new town in South Texas, is warning existing residents that they may lose their property rights. **A15**
The CBO projected that Trump's budget bill would lead to \$550 billion in new interest payments for the federal government. **A20**

THE REGION
The superintendent for Prince George's schools defended his tenure after the county teachers union issued a vote of no confidence. **B1**
A federal judge began what could be a long process in the release of Martin Luther King Jr.'s FBI records. **B1**

STYLE
The director of the National Portrait Gallery has continued working in defiance of Trump. **C1**
WEEKEND
Wes Anderson's new movie, "The Phoenix Scheme," bears the filmmaker's trademark charm, plus some surprising relevance.

BUSINESS NEWS.....A15
COMICS.....C5
OBITUARIES.....B4
OPINION PAGES.....A17
TELEVISION.....C4
WORLD NEWS.....A10

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